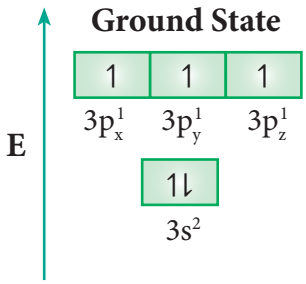
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sp^3d Hybridisation:

In the molecules such as PCl_5, the central atom phosphorus is covalently bound to five chlorine atoms. Here the atomic orbitals of phosphorous undergoes sp^3d hybridisation which involves its one 3s orbital, three 3p orbitals and one vacant 3d orbital (d_{z^2}). The ground state electronic configuration of phosphorous is [Ne]$3s^2$ $3p_x^1$ $3p_y^1$ $3p_z^1$ as shown below.



One of the paired electrons in the 3s orbital of phosphorous is promoted to one of its vacant 3d orbital (d_{z^2}) in the excite state. One 3s orbital, three 3p orbitals and one $3d_{z^2}$ orbital of phosphorus atom mixes to give five equivalent sp^3d hybridised orbitals. The orbital geometry of sp^3d hybridised orbitals is trigonal bi-pyramidal as shown in the figure 10. x.

Overlap with $3p_z$ orbitals of chlorine:

The $3p_z$ orbitals of the five chlorine atoms linearly overlap along the axis with the five sp^3d hybridised orbitals of phosphorous to form the five P-Cl σ-bonds, as shown below.

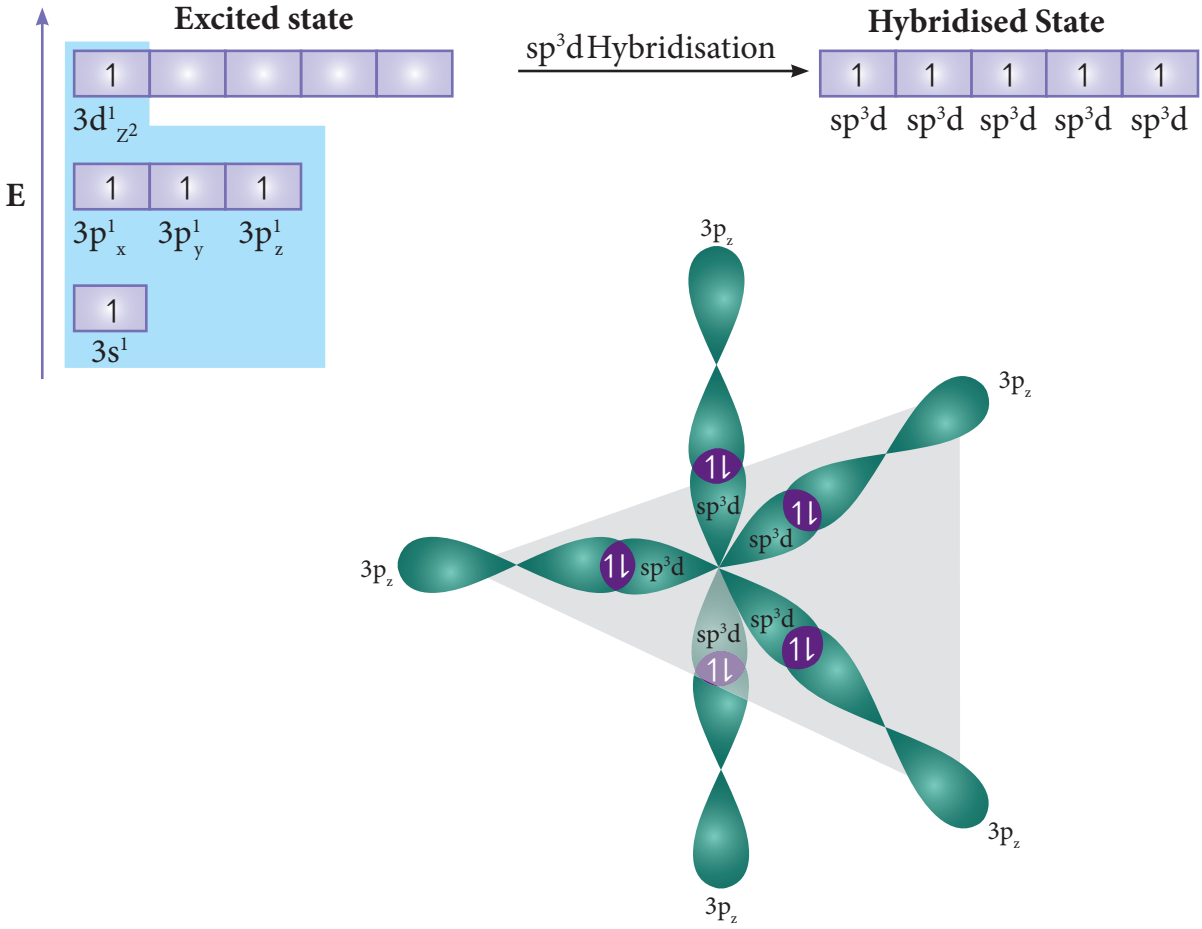


Fig 10.25 sp^3d Hybridisation PCl_5